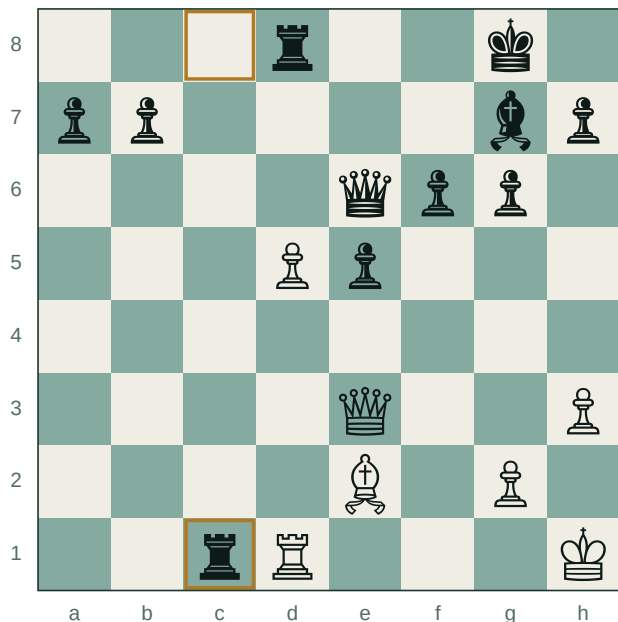


Active defensive resources: White, move 27

Active defensive resources

White to move



Previous move: 26...Rxc1. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

27. dxe6 Rdx d1+ 28. Bxd1 Rxd1+ 29. Kh2

27.dxe6 The pawn captures the queen on e6. The changed line means the rook on d1 attacks the rook on d8. Recorded reply: **27...Rdx d1+**.

28.Bxd1 The bishop captures the rook on d1. Recorded reply: **28...Rxd1+**.

29.Kh2 The king moves from h1 to h2.

At the end, nominal material is White 12 / Black 14 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +6. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +6: the balance goes from -8 to -2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A defensive puzzle may aim to preserve equality rather than win. Judge success against the threat, not only the final material count.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

The best defense may create a threat, exchange an attacker, or change the geometry of the attack. Identify the opponent's concrete idea before selecting a response.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the threatened move and the conditions it requires. Look for a move that breaks one of those conditions with tempo.

The defending king is on g8. Geometrically undefended: rook on d8 and queen on e6. Check for tactical protection.